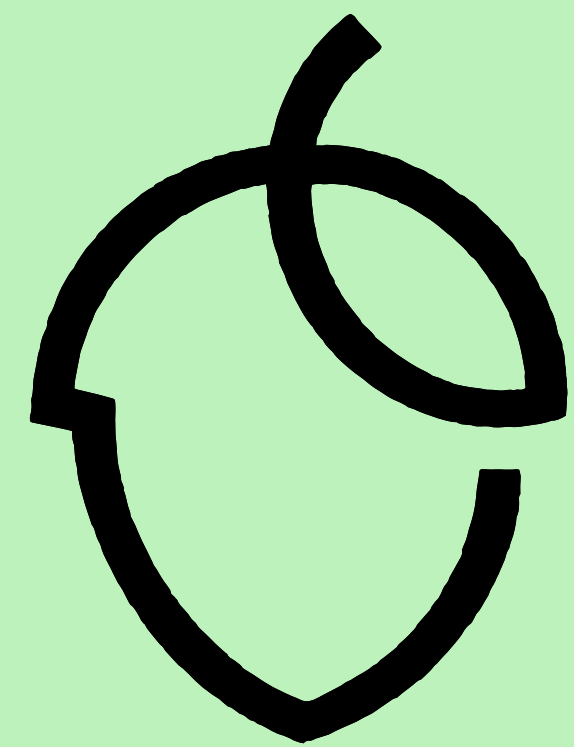
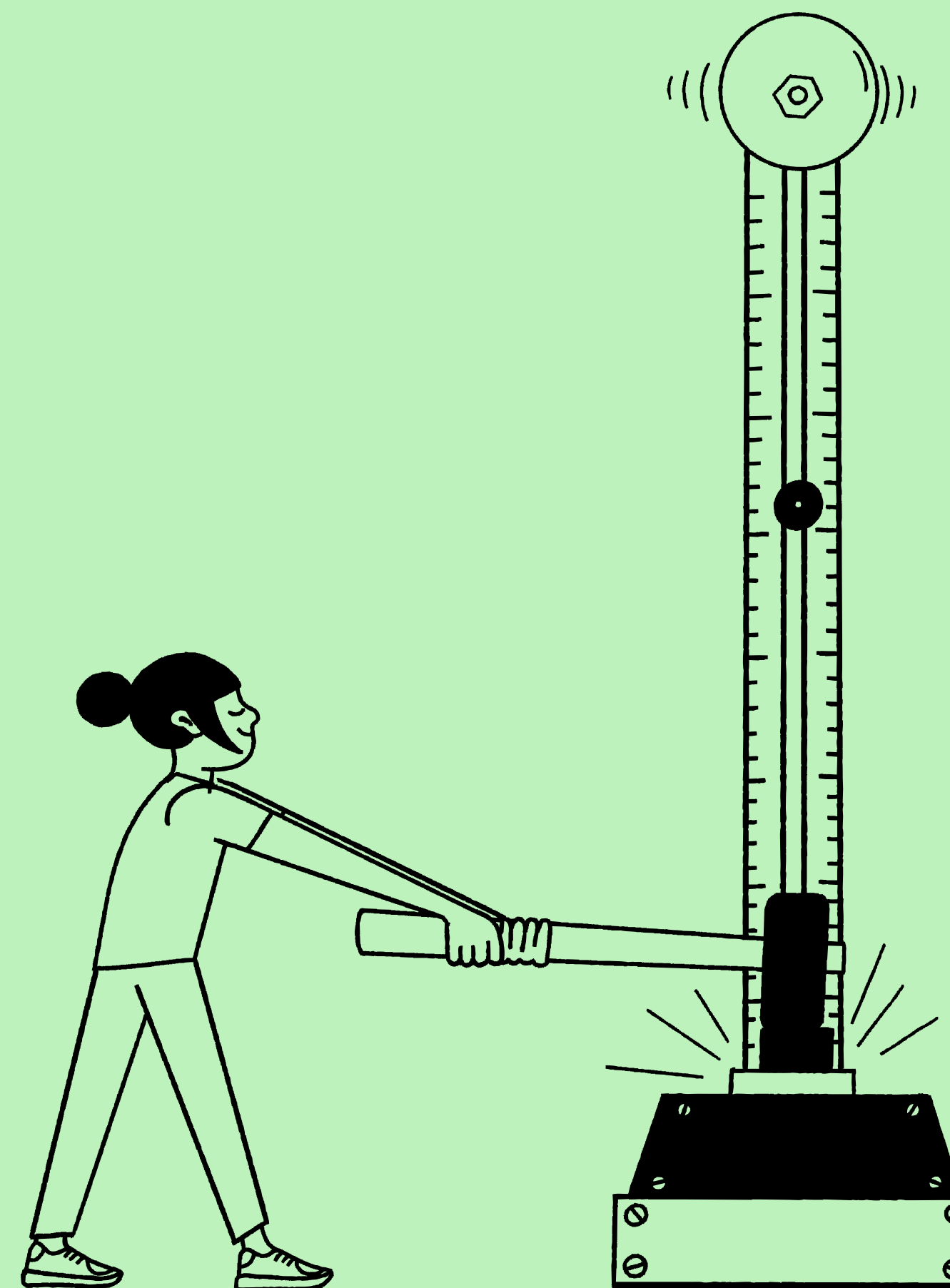




**Oak
National
Academy**

Brand guidelines

Version 3.0
September 2023



Introduction

Welcome to our brand guidelines.

This document has been created to help those creating designs and application for Oak.

Following these examples will help you create on-brand communications that are considered, engaging and consistent.



Oak: as a brand

We've evolved

Oak's identity was born in 2020, taking "inspiration from the moment than an acorns falls to the ground and sparks something new". We've stayed true to our roots, but we've grown up: our open-ended acorn symbolises our future, and we've modernised our recognisable green tones.

Everyone welcome

We're professional, but we're also incredibly friendly and open-hearted in everything we do: that's why we've opted for positive pastel palettes, a clean but playful design, and little touches of illustrated fun – to engage with professionals from all walks of life.

Humanising the digital

We're based online, but our resources manage to make their way into thousands of busy classrooms across the country. Our brand is fitting of any typical classroom, with a invitingly bright colours and a hand-drawn style to keep our resources approachable to both teacher and pupil.

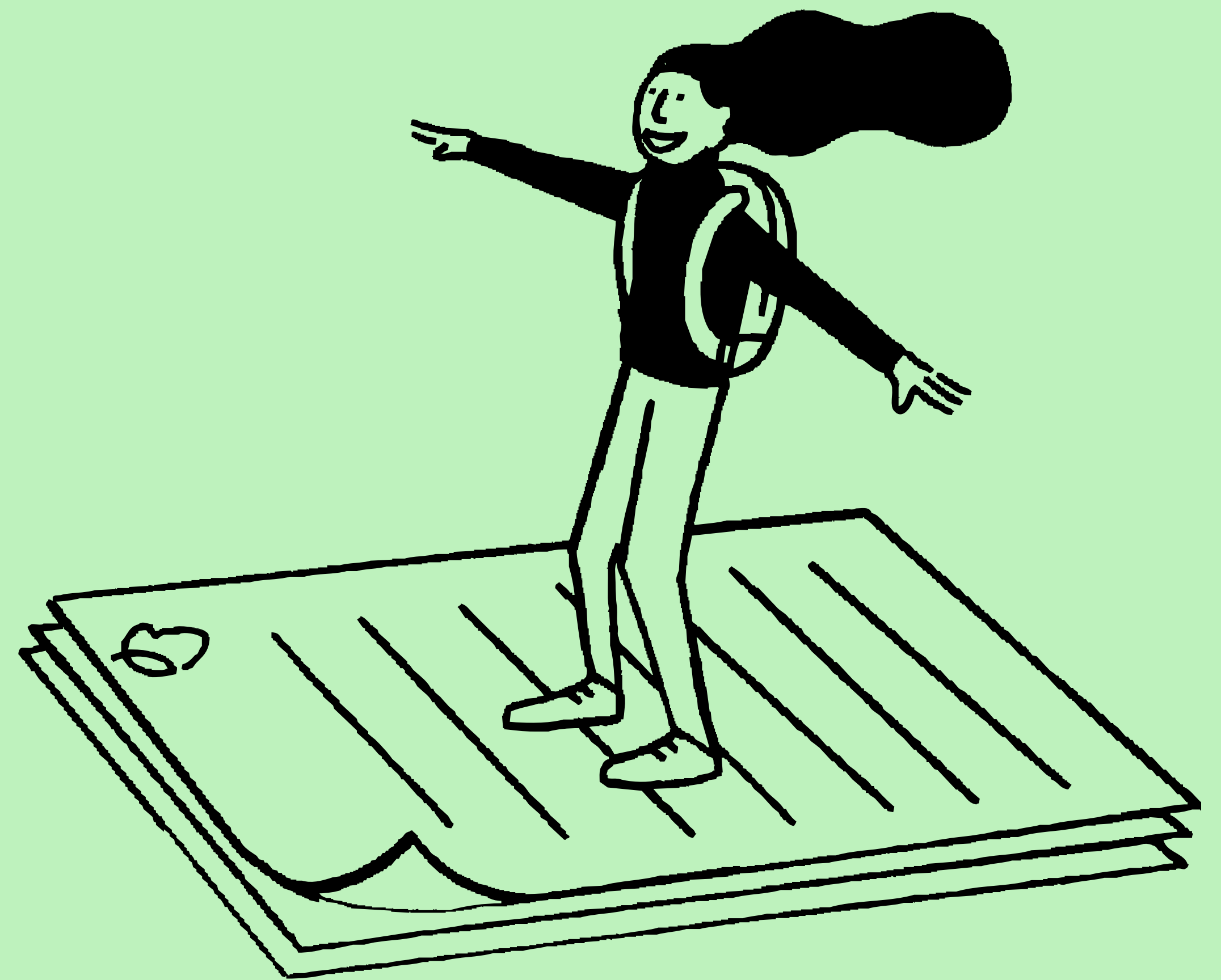
Illustrating the point

We're here to inspire teachers, helping them to apply and explore ideas – and education is full of fascinating, yet complex ideas. We use illustrations to communicate these ideas, bringing abstract concepts to life with a humble, hand-drawn style.

Clarity above all

Oak is accessible to all, and this means we keep our visuals tidy and our messages clear. We use graphic devices to emphasise key points, rather than decoratively. We use illustrations to paint pictures in a reader's mind, but we don't provide distracting detail.

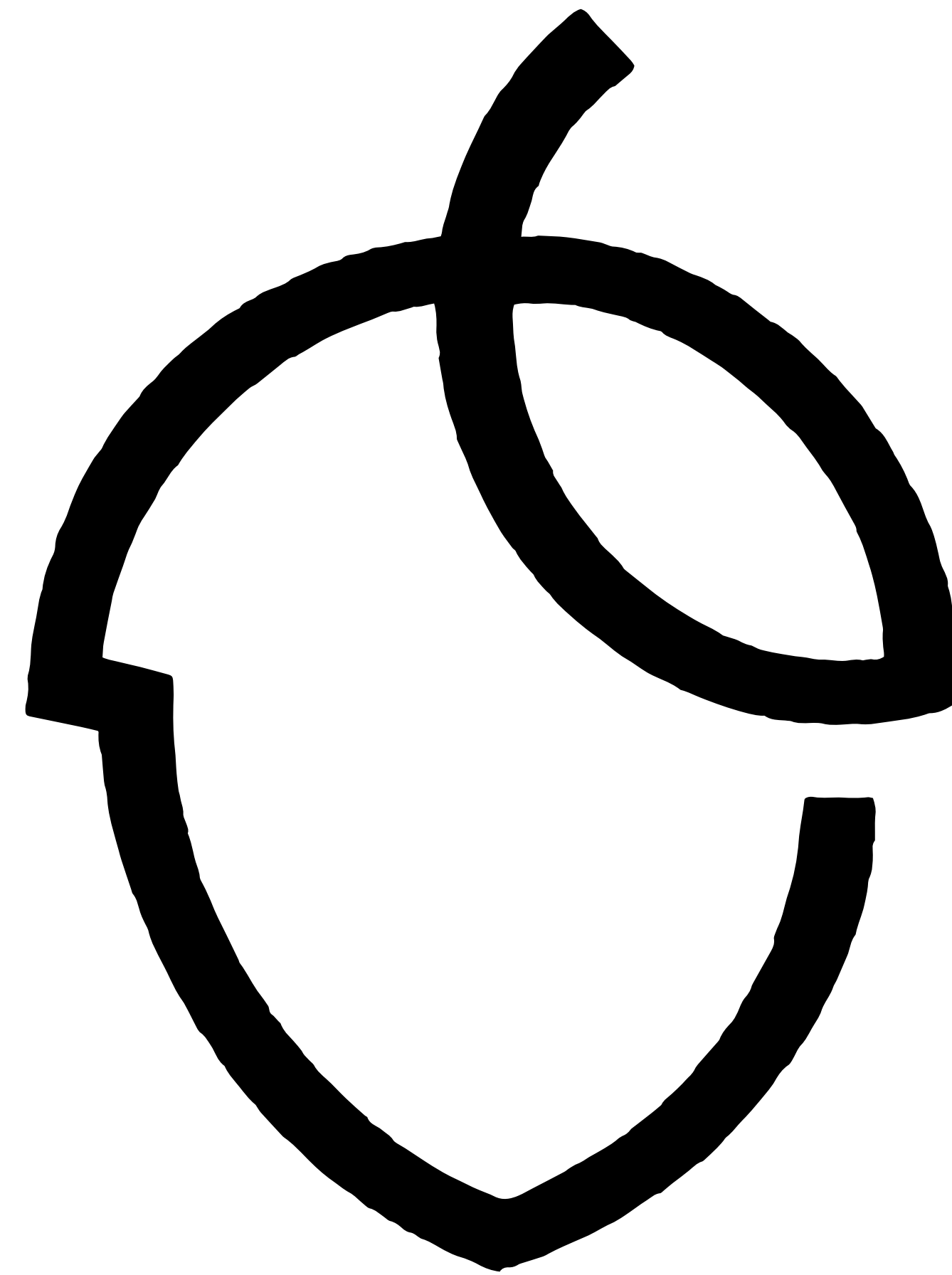
Logos



The Oak acorn

Our acorn is a single-line drawing, symbolising the journey of learning and the continuous transformation that it entails.

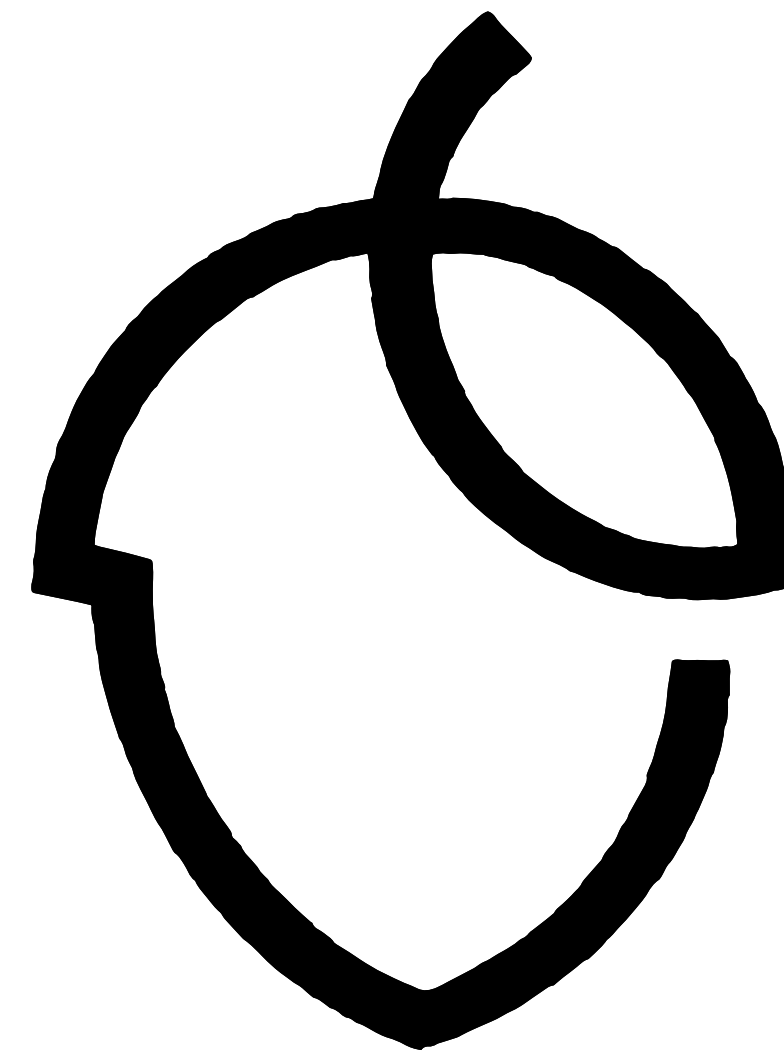
The acorn can be used on its own if the wording 'Oak National Academy' is present prominently nearby.



Core logo

Our logo is composed of our symbol and logotype. The core logo is shown here. This is the version we most commonly use.

We do not use the logotype on its own, it must always be paired with the acorn.



**Oak
National
Academy**

Logo variations

For long and thin applications, such as headers and footers, a wide version of the logo has been created.

Again, we do not use the logotype on its own, it must always be paired with the acorn.



Colour variations

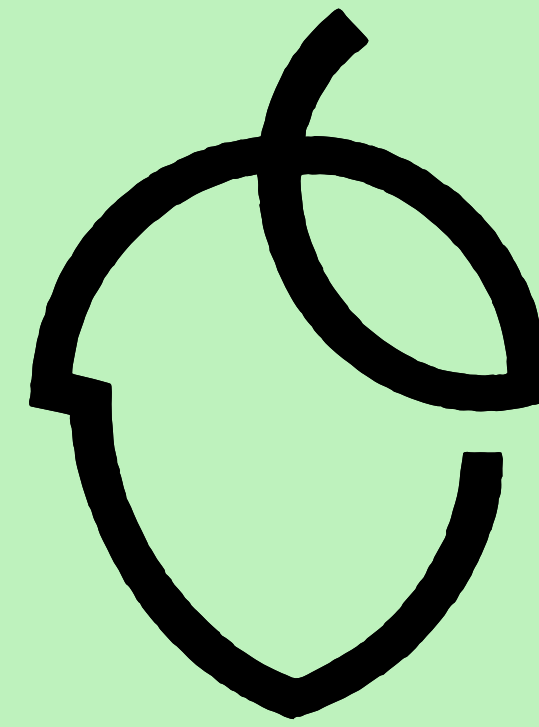
Our logo comes in two colourways. When choosing which to use, ensure both the logotype and symbol are fully legible.

Black

For use on light or white backgrounds, when the symbol and logotype are both legible. This version should be the most commonly used.

White

For use on deep, dark grey or black backgrounds, when the symbol and logotype are both legible. This version should only be used where necessary for accessibility.



**Oak
National
Academy**



**Oak
National
Academy**

Clearspace

We reference a clearspace around our logo to help it stand out in designs.

Clearspace is calculated using the 'O' of 'Oak'; do not place any designed objects in the clearspace shown here. The clearspace also acts as a margin; when placing the logo in a composition, leave at least this space between the logo and the edge of the layout. This is a suggested margin, but it can be increased.

Leave at least 3 'O's when placing our logo next to another logo, with our logo on the left.

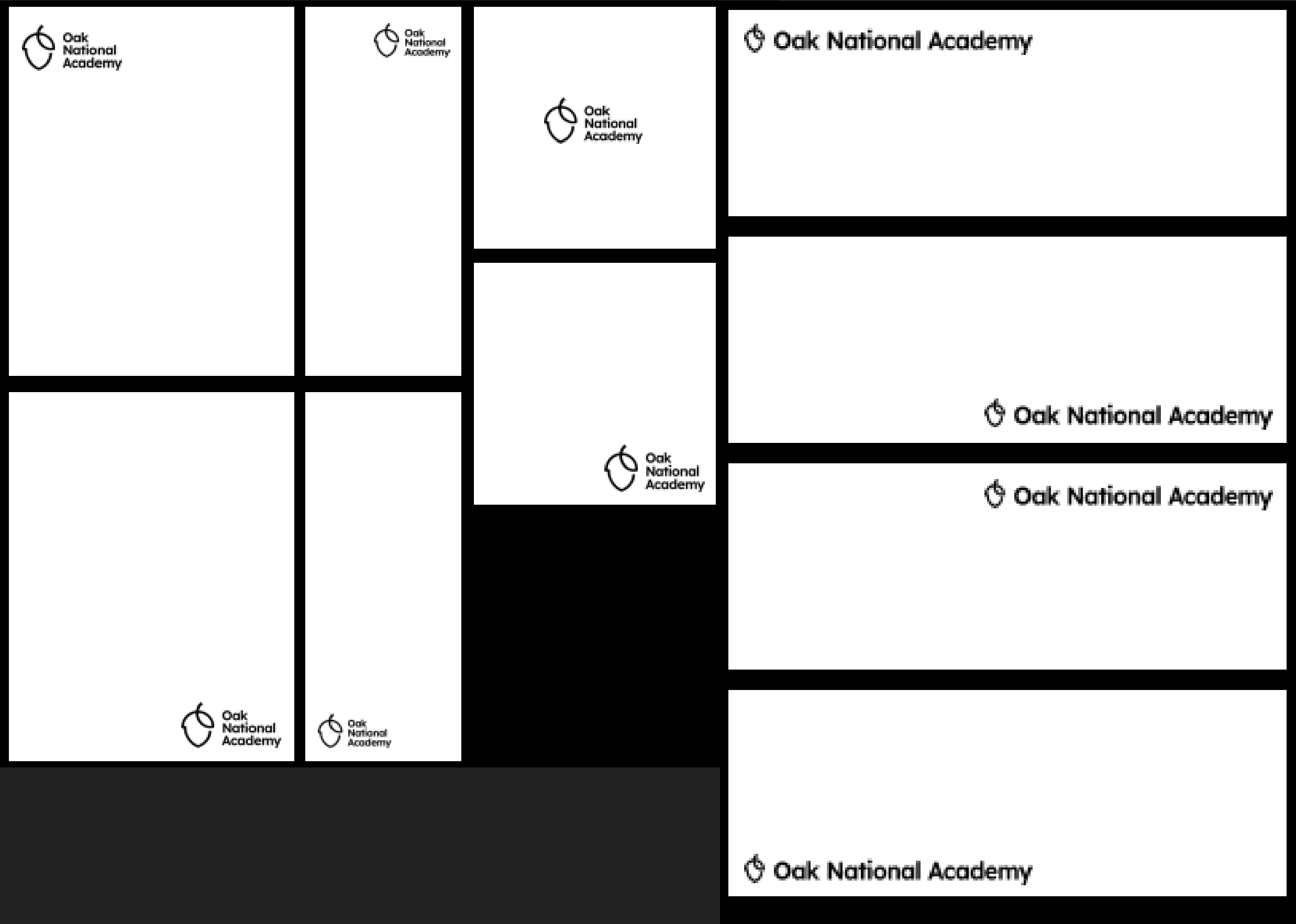


Placement

Our design system is flexible and the placement of our logo should be dictated by layout, legibility and imagery. As long as we observe the clearspace rule, the core and wide logos can be placed in any corner, on either side or centered in the document ensuring it is clearly visible and legible.

When use of the core logo is not appropriate, use the wide logos for wide designs

To be updated

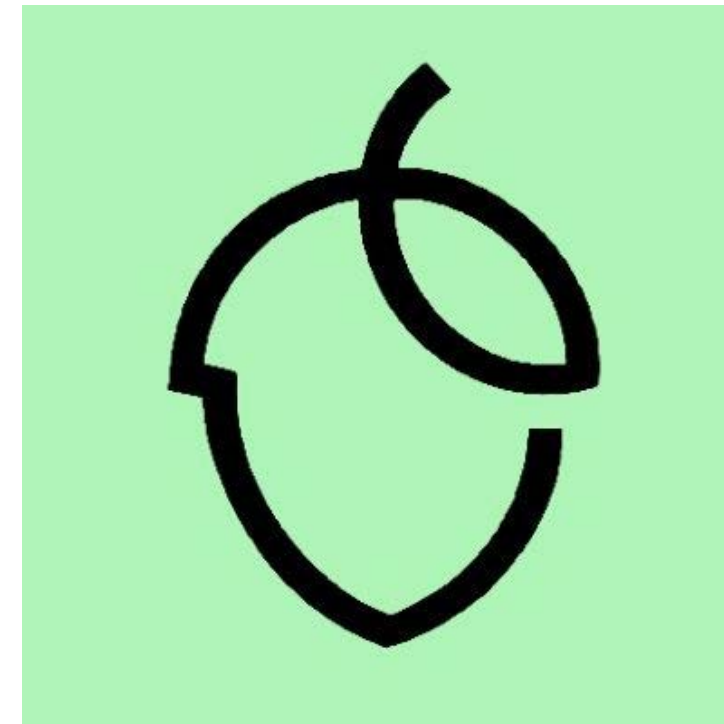


On screen

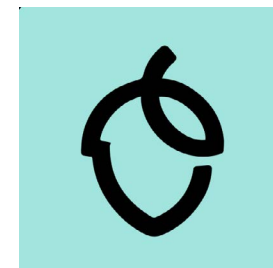
We use various online platforms to host profiles for Oak, including social media applications, e.g. [Twitter](#), Facebook, Instagram, LinkedIn. Where a profile image is required, we use our symbol centered on a mint circle. This also extends to other, less obvious examples of networks where we might have a profile, such as Applied, Glassdoor, HR Partner, and so on.

Our favicon uses the acorn adjusted for small sizes, on various backgrounds from our core palette (or in monochrome if necessary).

Social media



Favicon



Misuse

Here are examples of what not to do with our logo.



Colour



Core palette

Primary colours

Mints lead our brand, with a strong leading colour and two tints to complement and contrast. We use all three flexibly, but tints should especially be used when working with lots of text.

Accent colour

This darker green is our accent colour. It should be used sparingly and in small amounts, for emphasis or impact. It must be layered against mints or white.

Black and white

Our palette includes pure white and an off-black, predominantly to be used for text.

Mint #BEF2BD	Mint 50 #DFF9DE	Mint 30 #EBFBEB
Green #287C34		
White #FFFFFF	Black #222222	

Secondary palette

We use these colours to complement our core palette. We've chosen these pastel colours as they're fun and inviting, without being too bright.

We use all of the original shades meaningfully – as buttons, decorative graphics, backgrounds for blocks of key messages. We avoid using them as backgrounds when working with lots of text.

We use tints flexibly, but especially when we need a greater contrast.

Aqua #B0E2DE	Aqua 50 #CEE7E5	Aqua 30 #E7F6F5
Pink #DEB7D5	Pink 50 #E5D1E0	Pink 30 #F5E9F2
Lemon #FFE555	Lemon 50 #F6E8A0	Lemon 30 #FFF7CC
Lavender #A0B6F2	Lavender 50 #C6D1EF	Lavender 30 #E3E9FB

Colour accessibility

It is important to ensure all typography is legible when using our colour palette. We have demonstrated acceptable colour combinations here.

For our pastel colours, text must always be in black. Do not use these colours for text; however, black text can be highlighted using these colours.

As our accent colour, a green and white combination can be used for large text only, and in small amounts,

White must always be used on black.

16.62 WCAG AAA	18.74 WCAG AAA	19.53 WCAG AAA
14.77 WCAG AAA	16.18 WCAG AAA	18.89 WCAG AAA
11.84 WCAG AAA	14.52 WCAG AAA	17.82 WCAG AAA
16.59 WCAG AAA	16.96 WCAG AAA	19.96 WCAG AAA
10.46 WCAG AAA	13.76 WCAG AAA	17.31 WCAG AAA
5.22 WCAG AA	5.22 WCAG AA	
15.9 WCAG AAA	15.9 WCAG AAA	

Typography



Brand typeface

Our brand typeface is Lexend, and we use all weights from Light to Bold. As a guide, use SemiBold for headings and Light for paragraph text.

Lexend is an open-source Google font and readily available in Google applications, but you will likely need to download it for other uses. It is free to download.

[Download Lexend](#)

Our choice of fallback font is Arial, chosen for its accessibility. Where Lexend is not available, Arial can be used as a substitute.

Lexend Light (300)

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
0123456789?!.@<>+==()

Lexend Regular (400)

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
0123456789?!.@<>+==()

Lexend Medium (500)

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
0123456789?!.@<>+==()

Lexend SemiBold (600)

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
0123456789?!.@<>+==()

Lexend Bold (700)

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
0123456789?!.@<>+==()

Typographic styling

When it comes to marketing communication, we can make our typography work a little harder.

Keeping with the notion of a live, energetic brand, we can use our heading styles in the same way.

Using our graphic toolkit, use our brushes to fill in headlines, our graphic shapes to highlight, shapes to house and tilt our type ever so slightly to take on a hand-made, dynamic feel.

If using these techniques, use them with care, and use them singularly. Do not use different styles together.

This is our main heading style

Illustrate the point

Outlined text can draw attention to short, impactful information, like statistics and bold statements, so we use it rarely and effectively. Use joined-up, black outlines, and either a transparent or white fill.



three hours

Highlight keywords

Colour has impact

Remember

Don't combine different styles. Keep things easy to understand.

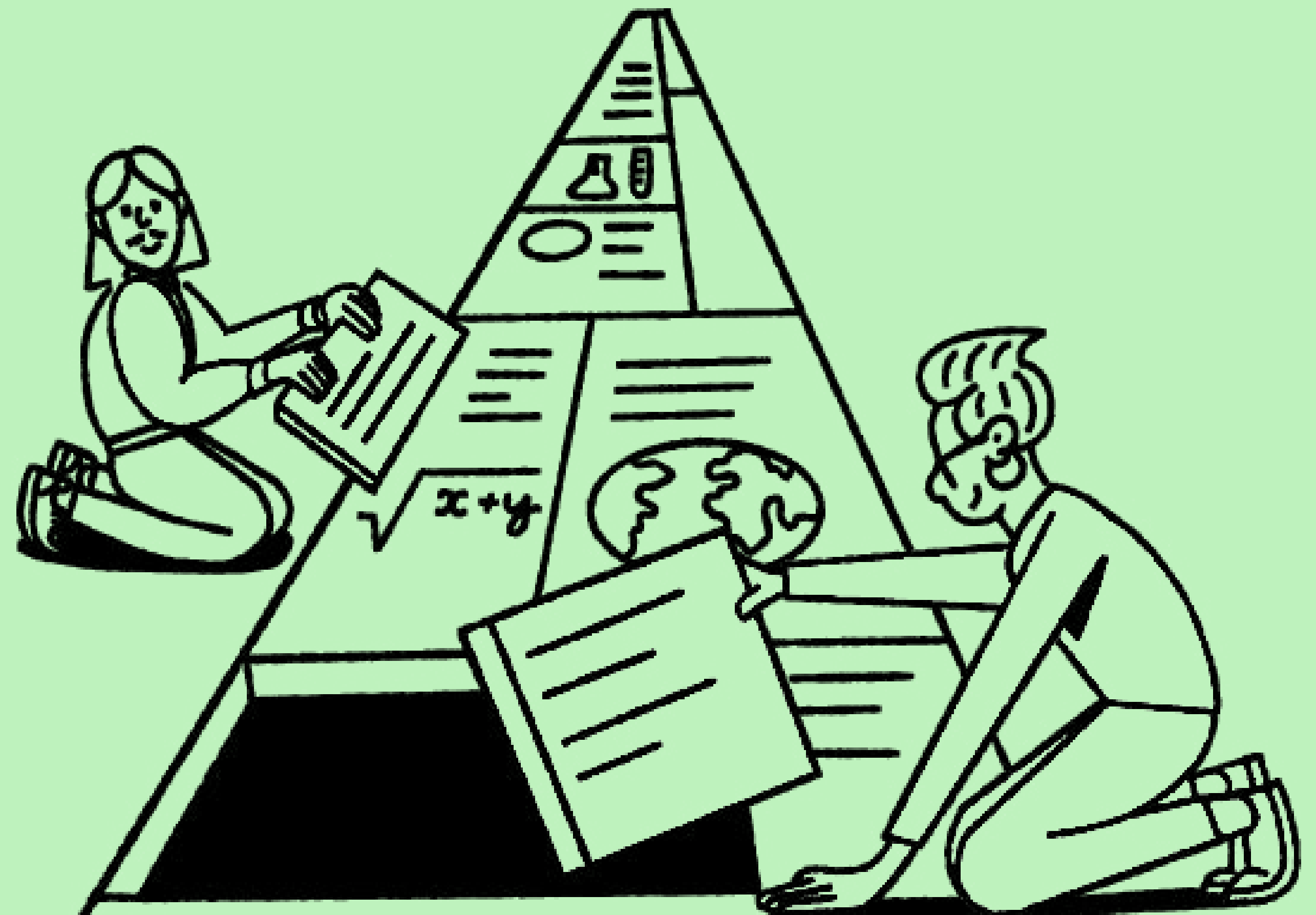
Sometimes we're
a little tilted

because we're
made by hand

-3°

2°

Illustrations



Hero illustrations

We use illustration to inject joy into our brand, and as a way to turn complex ideas into accessible concepts. Our hero illustrations represent our personality and voice in an efficient and clear way. They thoughtfully convey ideas and tell stories in a metaphorical and fantastical nature. They should therefore be used just as thoughtfully.

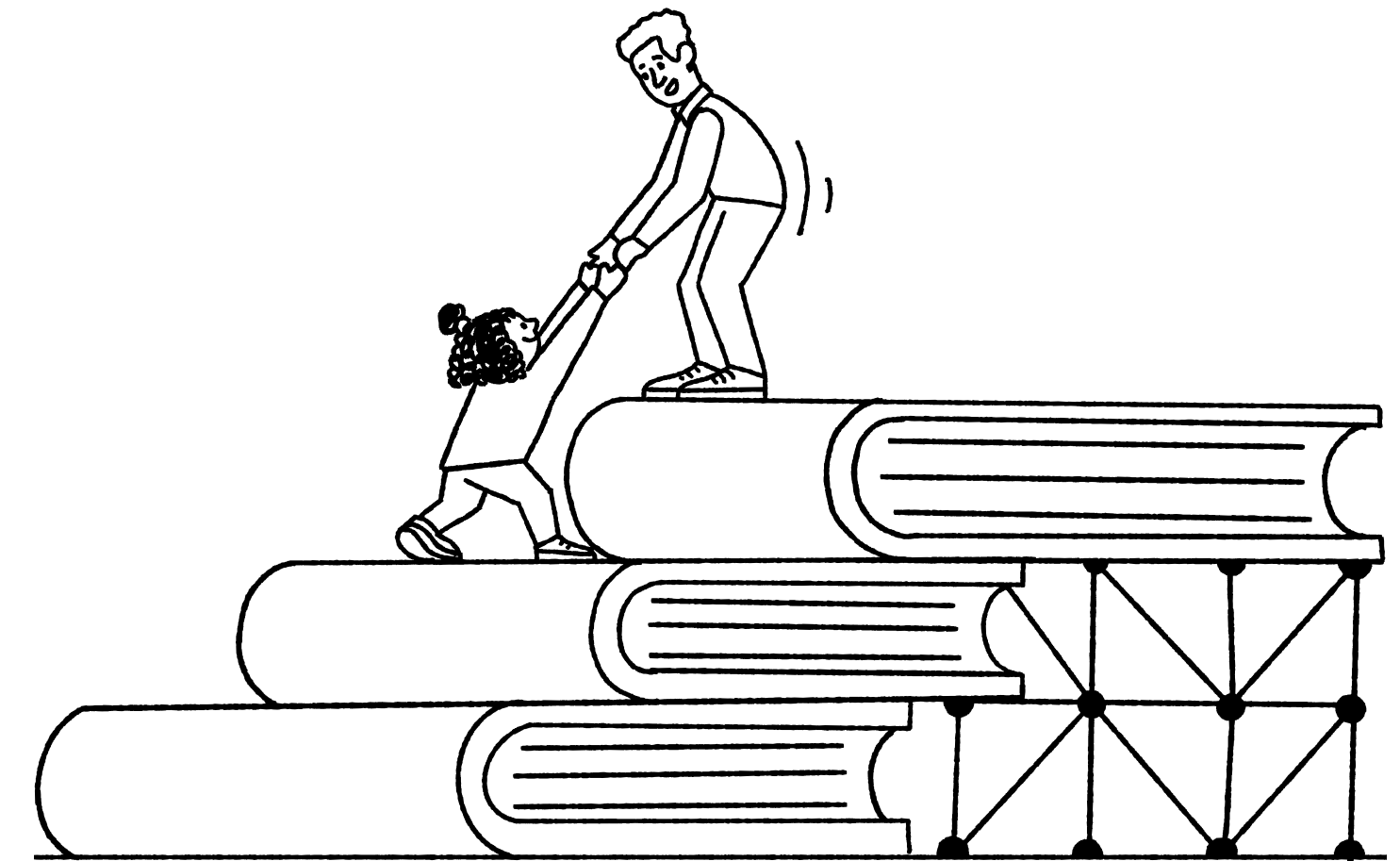
We have worked with illustrator Robert Hanson to create our initial set of illustrations. Robert's work is thought provoking, with a sense of humour and simplicity that all audiences can connect with.

Brief given to illustrator

"Scaffolding refers to the extra steps or support your pupils might need to reach the desired educational outcome. You can picture this process like building physical scaffolding too. Imagine that we all need to reach the top of a tower. The tower represents the journey that pupils must embark on to reach the pinnacle of their learning success."

"Whilst we share models of curricula sequences and teaching resources, we can never know the needs of a teachers' pupils. Only teachers have this expertise...Oak is not a fully finished product. Only teachers can bring it to life. We want to represent this idea of teachers taking static teaching resources and bringing them to life in the classroom."

Final illustration



Formatting

Our illustrations are always drawn with clean, joined-up, black lines. Line weight should be consistent across the illustration.

Illustrations should be used on a background of white or a colour from our core palette. Do not change the colour of the illustration line.

When using multiple hero images in one layout, ensure there is enough room between them so they do not compete or overcrowd a layout; they should be used at touchpoints to support copy, and should not distract or overshadow the key message.



Icons

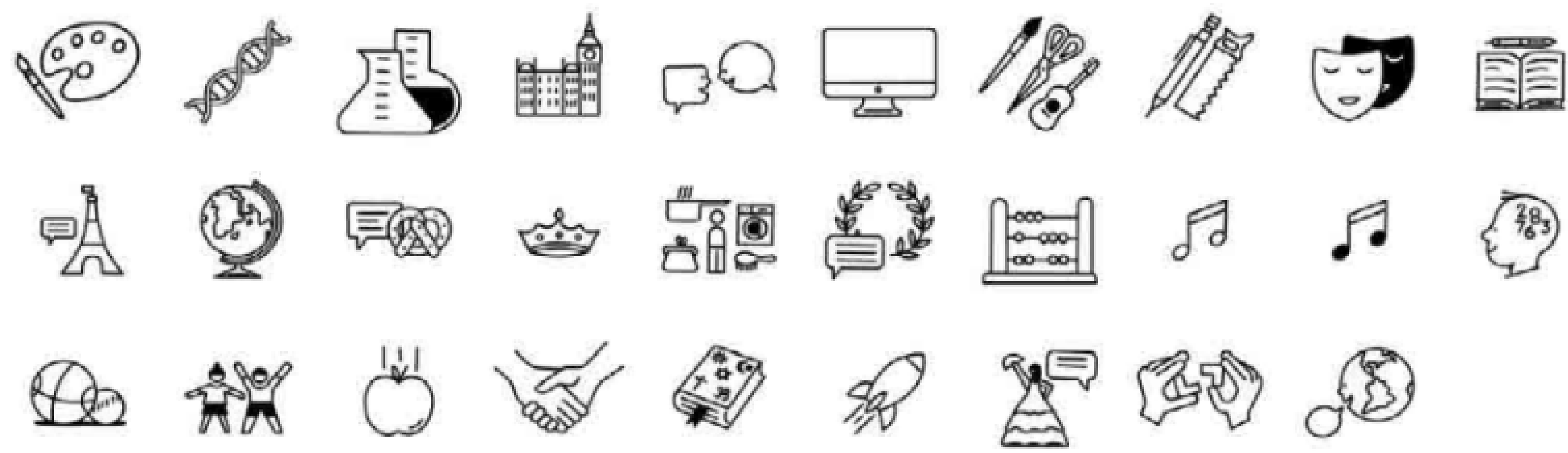
Icon illustrations are the simplest and most literal expression of a concept.

They are small, simple, hand-drawn, and black and white.

They usually do not include any people, but occasionally a hand or gesture to communicate an action.

Subject icons

To be updated

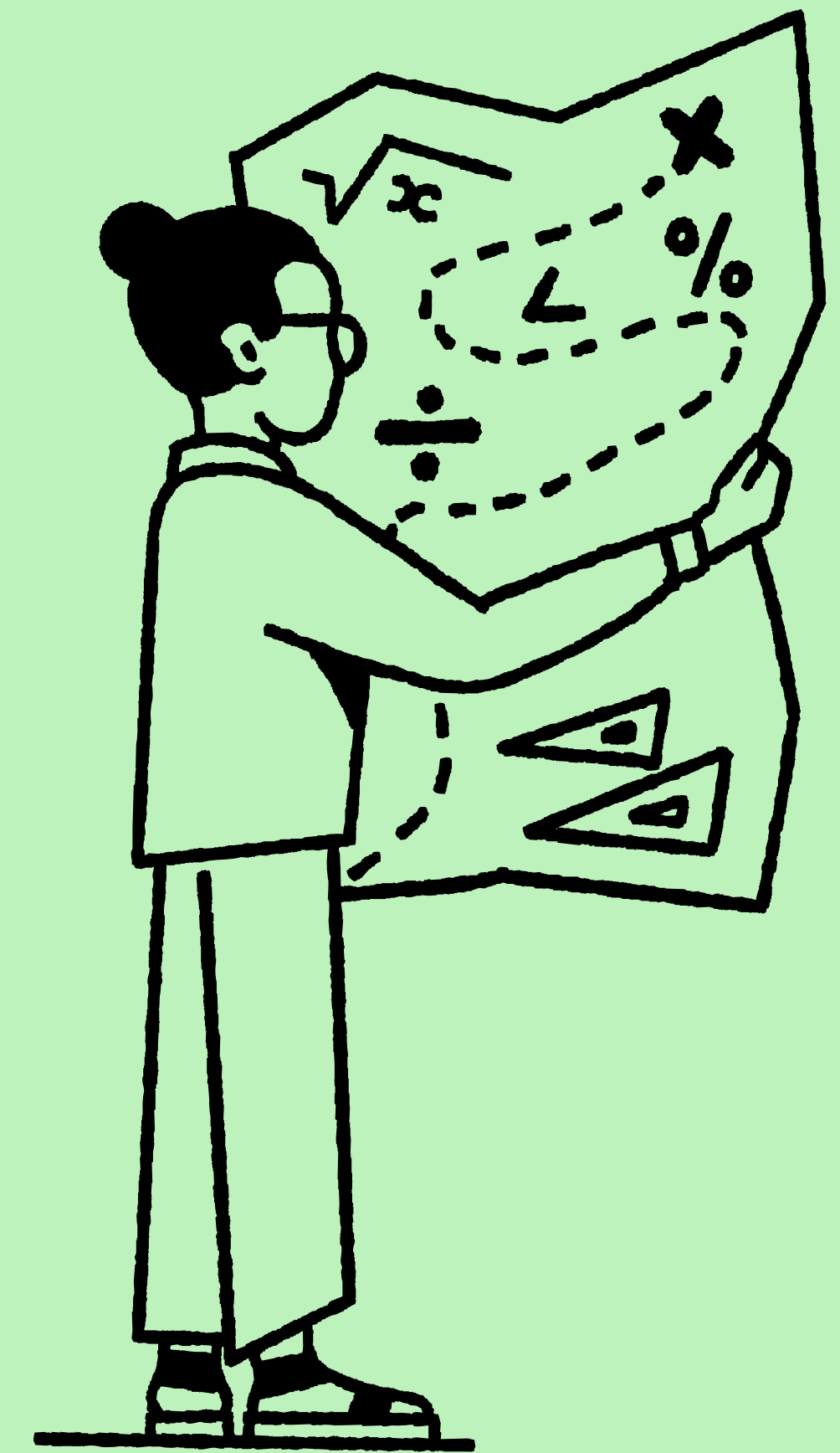


UX icons

To be updated



Graphic devices



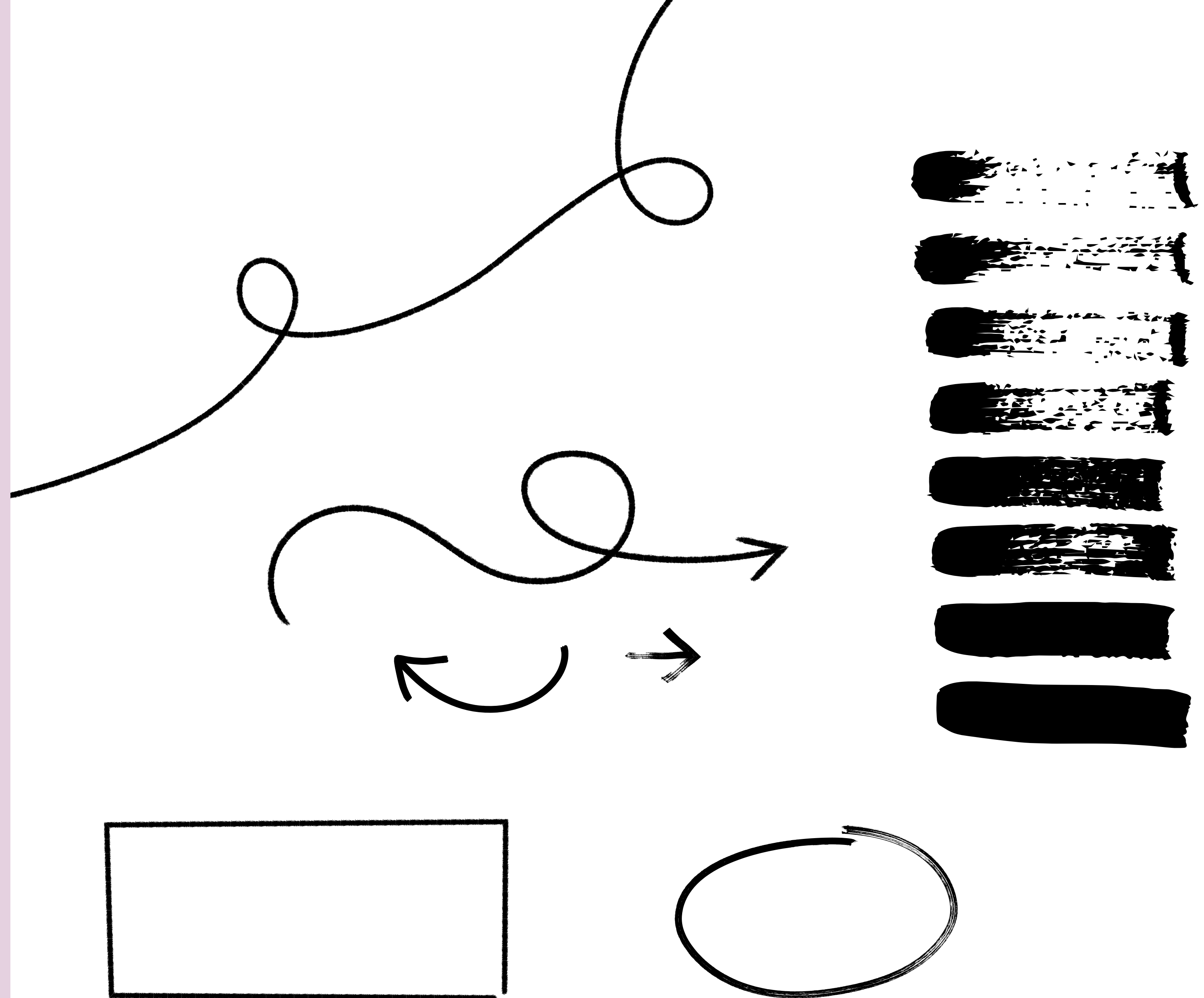
Graphic devices

We used graphic devices to add visual interest to our designs and/or highlight key messaging. They bring a handdrawn, classroom-like feel to our brand, with a flexuous quality and a brush that resembles a pencil line.

Devices can be used in black or white. They can be used to emphasise text, but must always be layered underneath, and never obstructive or distracting.

Devices can also be combined with photography.

Where multiple devices are used on one feature (e.g. a webpage, email), line weights should be consistent with one another.



Photography



Stock photography

We have our own bank of stock photos, featuring teachers and pupils,, as well as Oak products, in classroom settings.

These images portray the reality of the school environment – cluttered walls, busy desks, pupils deep in thought. Photos should have slightly warm tones but otherwise appear candid in their lighting and saturation.

Safeguarding

School logos may be present on uniforms, screen and posters in original photos. These **MUST** be removed before use.



To be updated



To be updated



Stock photography

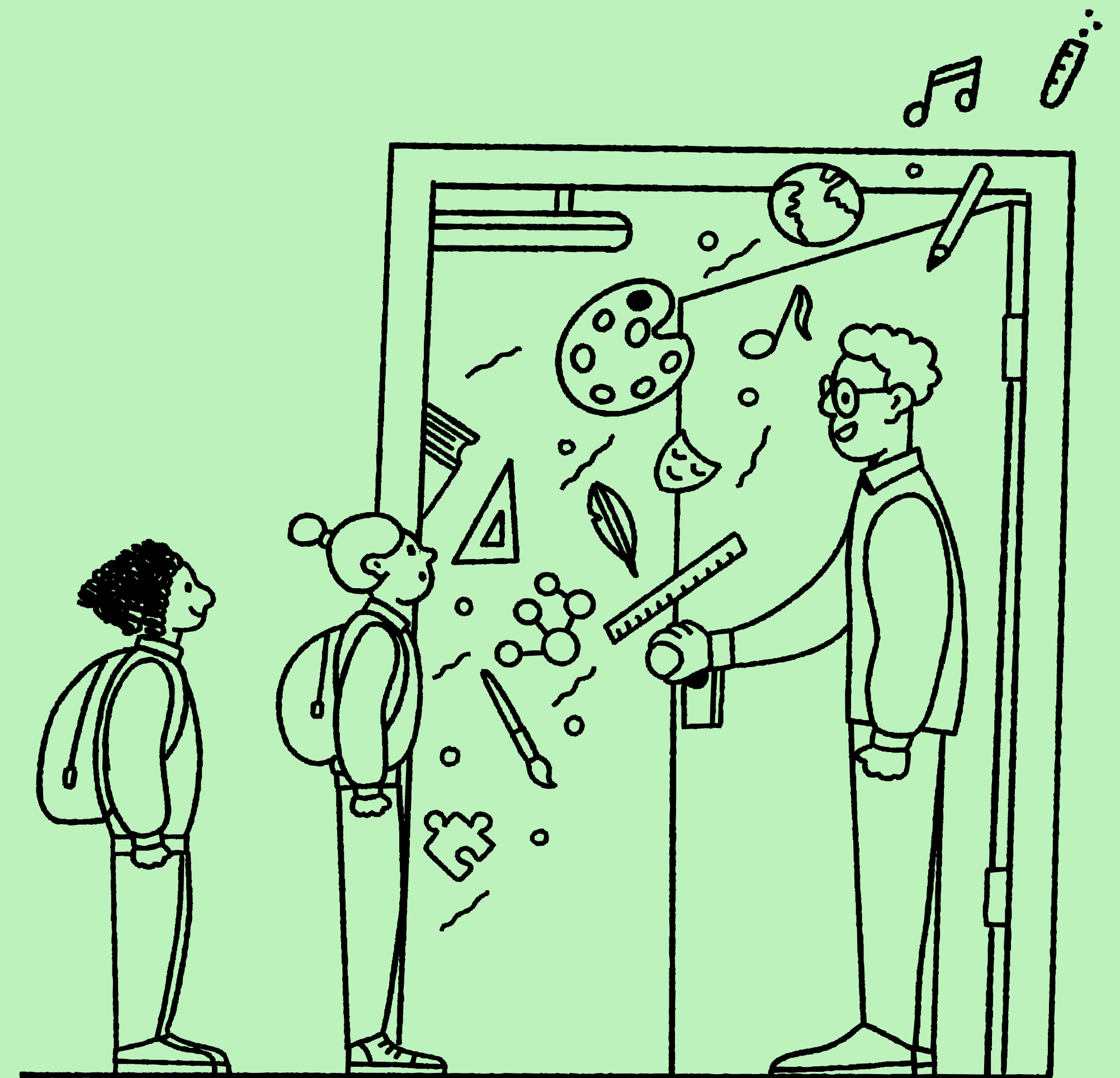
In addition to our own bank of photos, we also have access to a handful of stock photos with purchased licences. These can be used for specific needs.

Sourced stock images often lean away from the reality of a classroom, e.g. clean environments, unnatural facial expressions. Photos should therefore be selected with care.

It's also important to consider that other education organisations often source the same stock images, so these should be used in communications rarely and purposefully.



Video

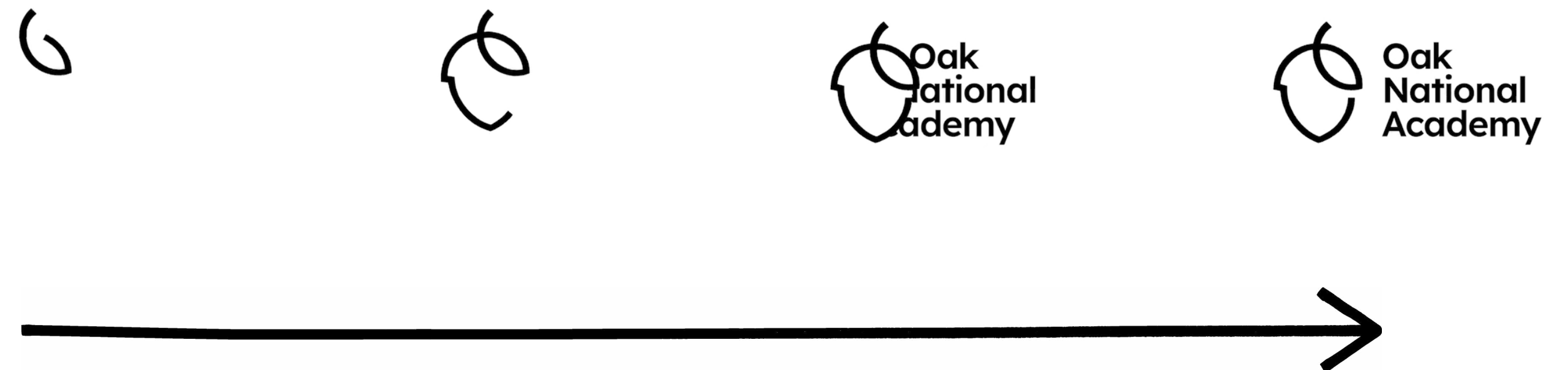


Logo

We have an animated logo which can be used in our videos.

We tend to use this to signify the end of a video, and avoid using it at the beginning.

The normal practice for logo use should be observed.

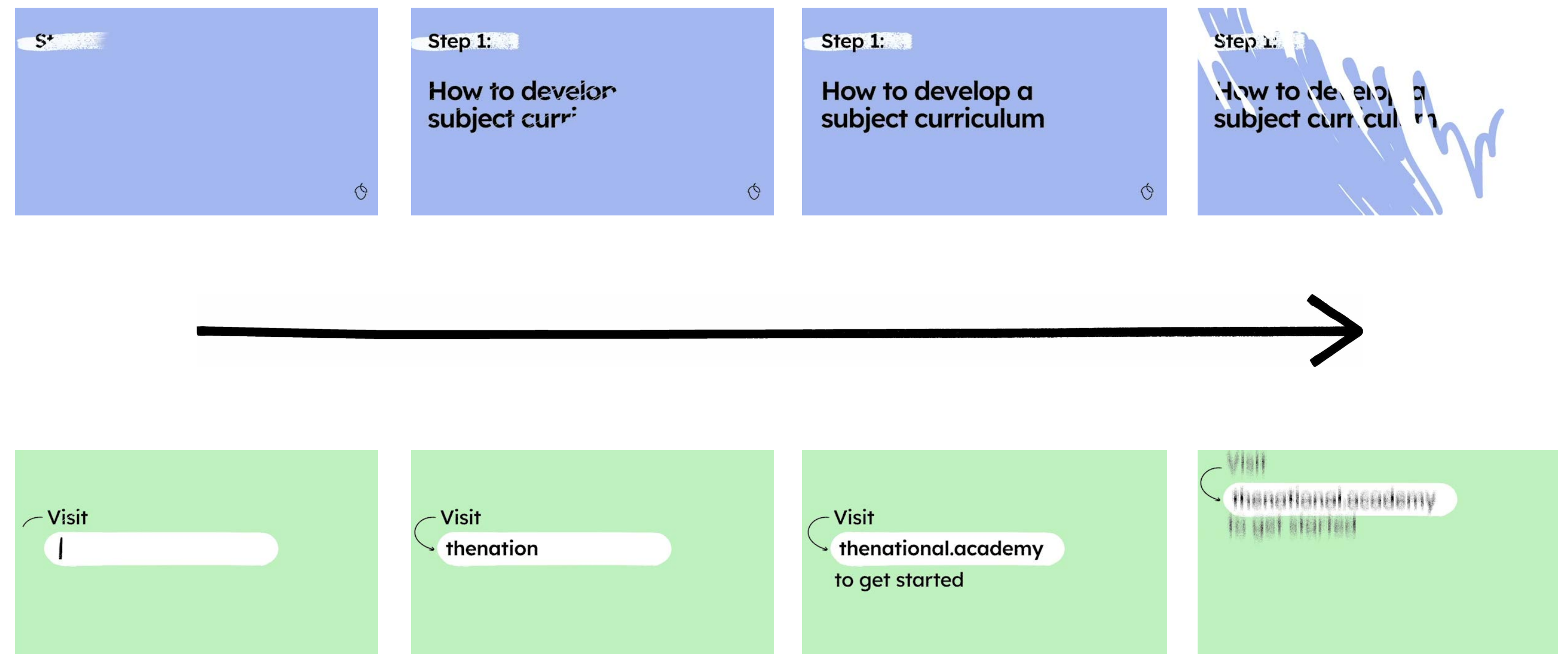


Templates

We have a series of animated templates that can be used as title and heading cards; used to introduce and break up sections of video.

They have solid backgrounds using our core palette, and black text.

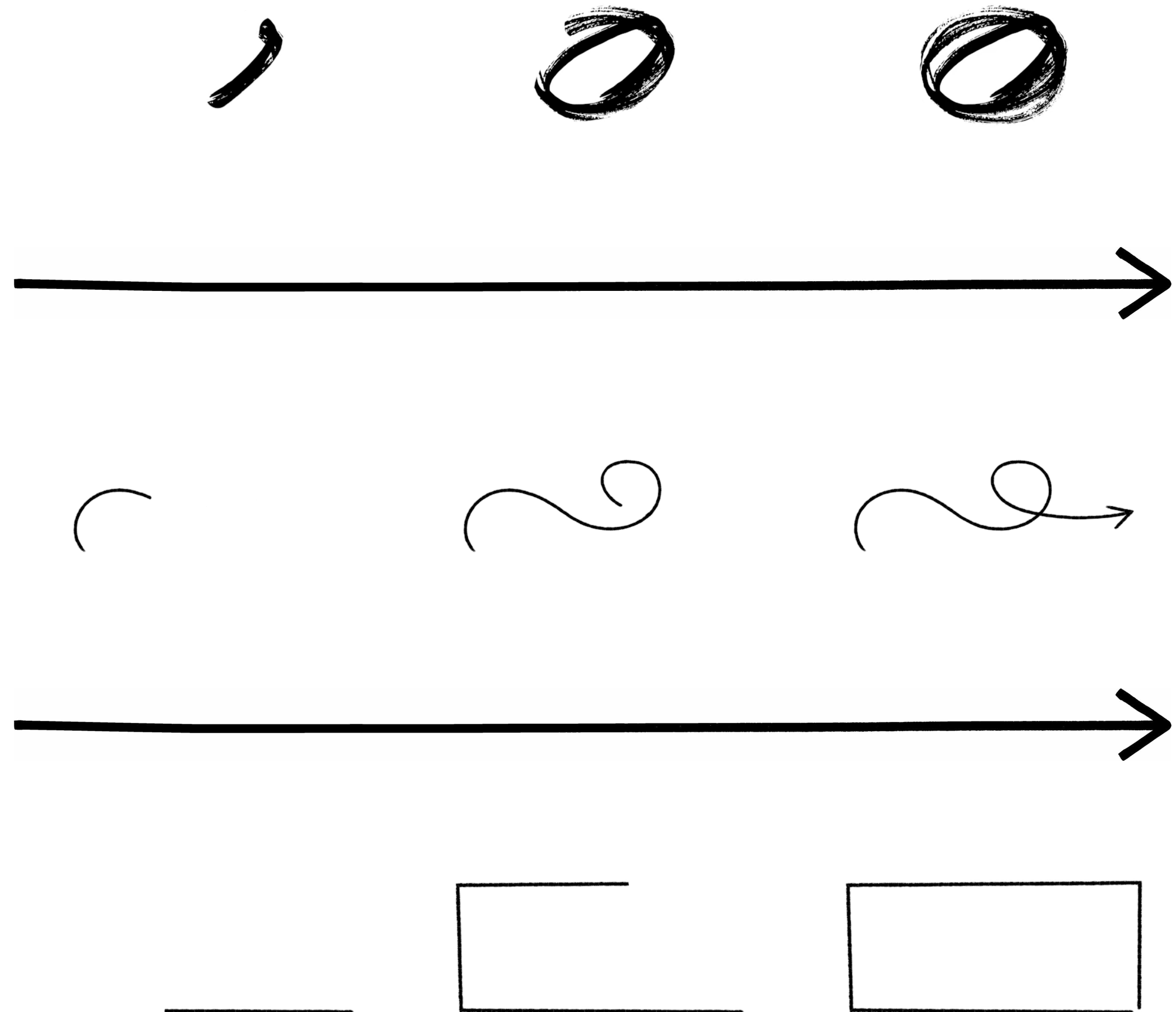
Transitions should be fun and reflect the brand where possible. For example, we have a custom 'scribble' layer that appears to erase video layers.



Animated graphic devices

We use animated graphic devices in our videos to emphasise and highlight key messages, but also bring our brand to life and inject fun into informational videos. They appear to be ‘drawn’ into frames.

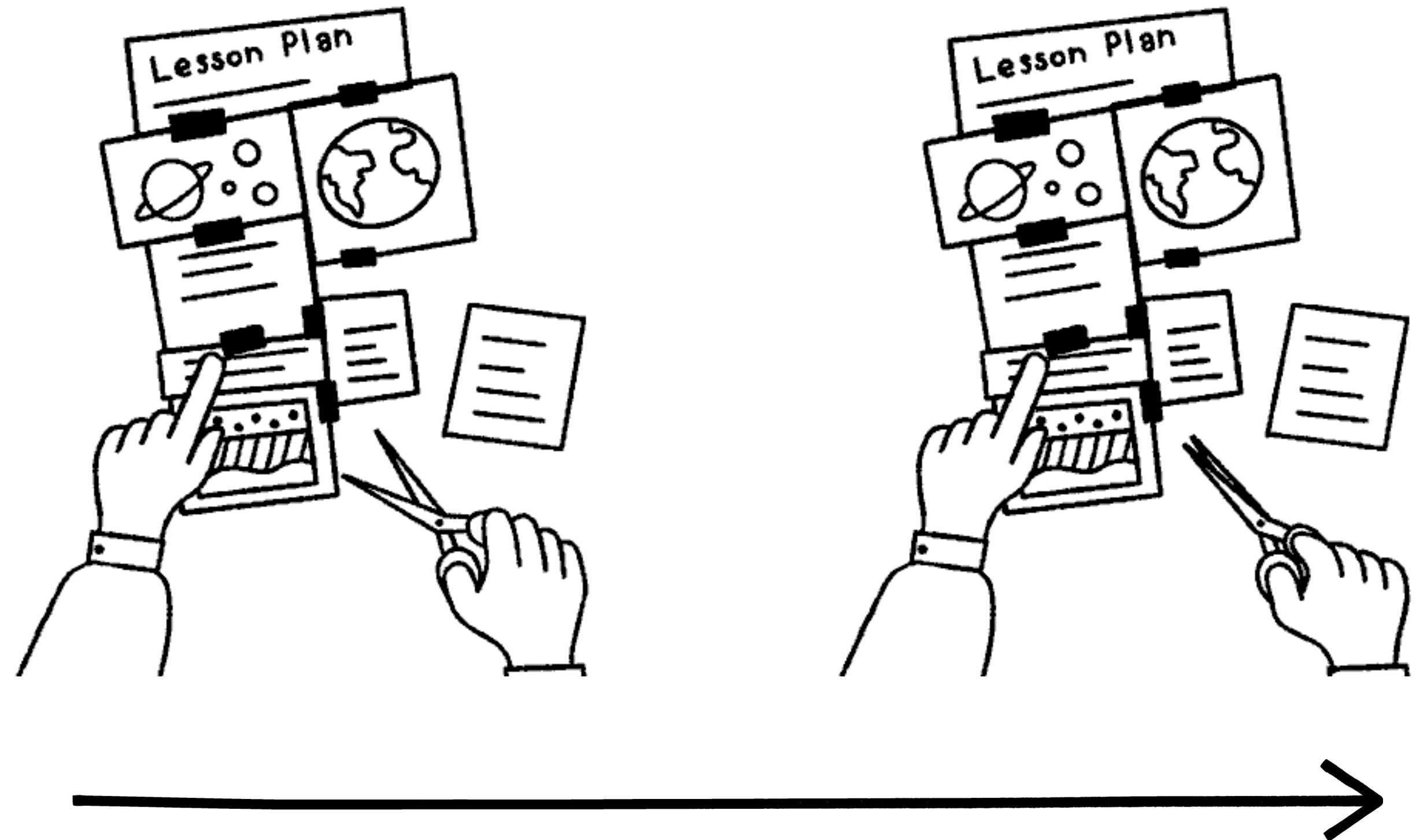
Graphic devices are transparent layers that can be placed over footage. Observe the same practice here that you would for static images; not intersecting lines, overlaying text etc.



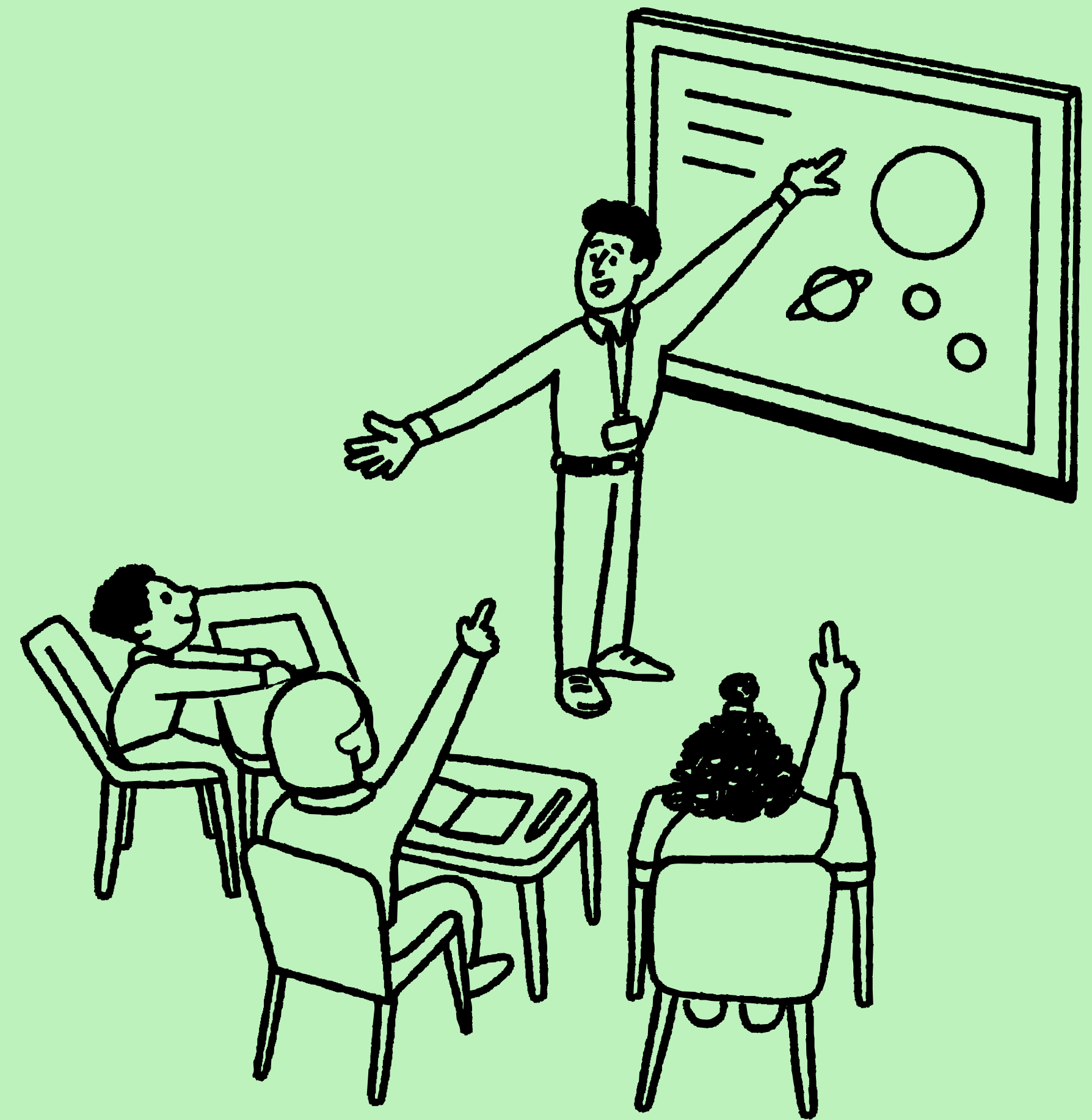
Animated illustrations

A handful of our illustrations have been redrawn with extra frames to allow for animation. We use these as GIFs and in videos.

Note that GIFs on the website should follow accessibility standards.



Our brand in practice





New Teaching resources ▾Curriculum mapsPupils' classroom

Search for lessons and topicsGo

Your foundation for great lessons

Free, adaptable teaching resources, including slide decks, worksheets, and quizzes at your fingertips.

Search

Search for lessons or topics

Or browse teaching resources by key stage

KS1

KS2

KS3

KS4



Slide decks

Worksheets

Quizzes

A black and white line drawing of two people, a woman and a man, sitting on the floor and looking at a large pyramid diagram. The pyramid is divided into sections containing various symbols: a triangle, a circle, a square, and a globe. The equation $x+y$ is written on the floor next to the pyramid.

Teachers & Curriculum Leads

Confidence in your curriculum

Inspire and inform your curriculum thinking using high-quality models that represent great design from across the sector.

- national curriculum-aligned

Key stage 1

Latest resources New

Explore our new teaching resources for 2023/24.



English

New

20 unit
134 lessons



Geography

New

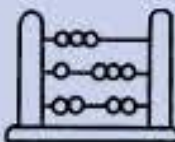
12 units
100 lessons



History

New

12 units
125 lessons



Maths

New

12 units
156 lessons



Science

New

15 units
125 lessons

All subjects

Explore all other teaching resources from previous academic years.



Art & Design

4 units | 20 lessons



Design & Technology

4 units | 40 lessons



Drama

2 units | 8 lessons



English

38 units | 370 lessons



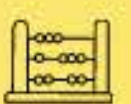
Geography

5 units | 45 lessons



History

6 units | 37 lessons



Maths

36 units | 378 lessons



Music

9 units | 54 lessons

A circular image showing a smiling female teacher with dark curly hair leaning over a desk, interacting with two young male students in school uniforms. They are looking at a tablet together in a classroom setting.

Your foundation for

great lessons

A thick, hand-drawn black arrow that starts under the word 'lessons' and points back towards the circular image of the teacher and students.

The logo for Oak National Academy, featuring a stylized black outline of an oak leaf inside a light green circle.

Oak National Academy

25K likes • 29K followers

A horizontal row of eight small, square profile picture avatars of various users.

Social media: static posts

“
It's a bank of high-quality resources that reduces my planning time and gives me a really strong starting point for planning any lesson.”

Helen,
Science Teacher



- ✓ Slide decks
- ✓ Worksheets
- ✓ Quizzes



Preparing for September?

There are SO many ways we can help...



If you have a brilliant curriculum or set of resources, we want to hear from you.



“
It's a bank of high-quality resources that reduces my planning time and gives me a really strong starting point for planning any lesson.”

Helen,
Science Teacher



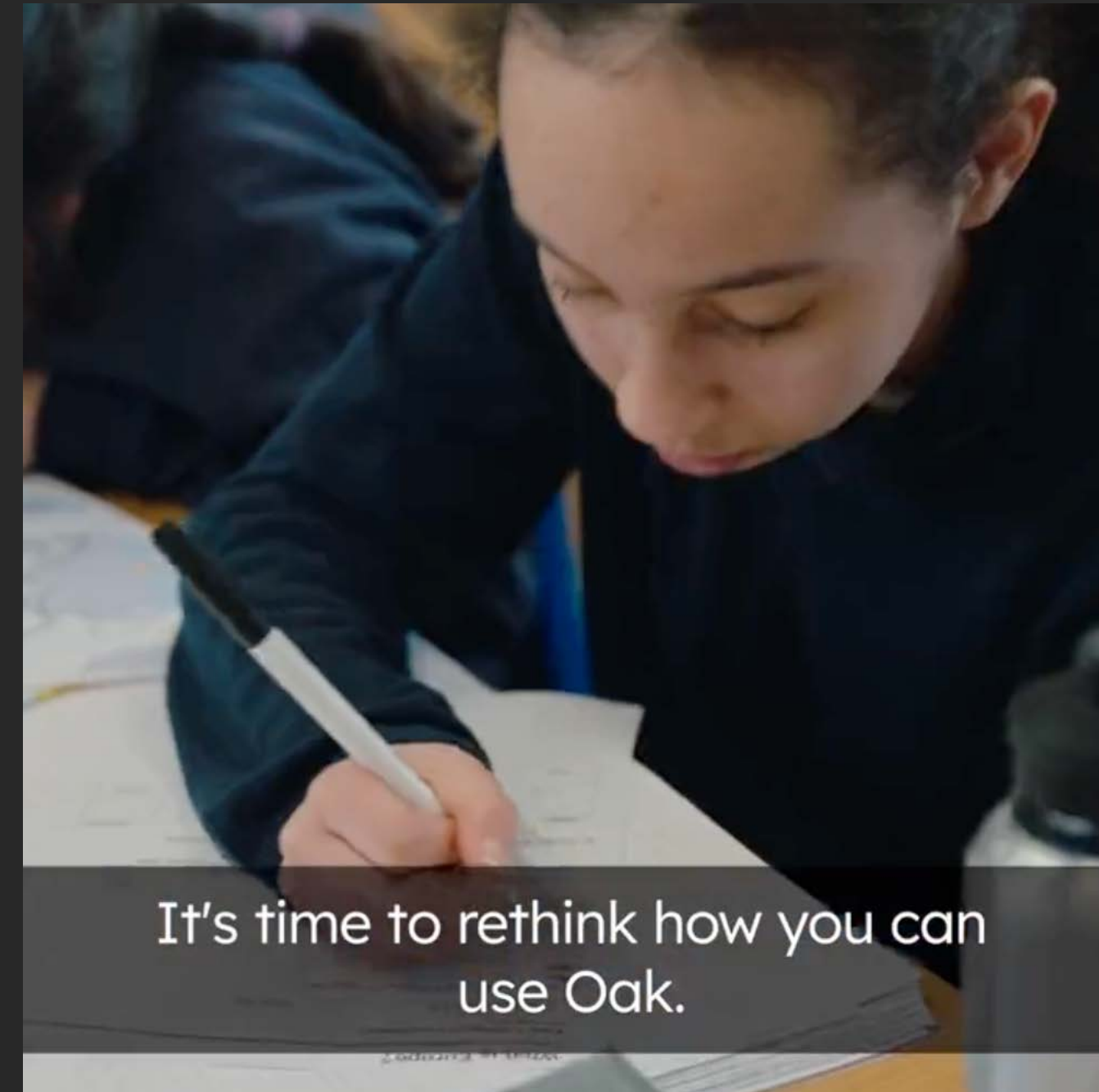
- ✓ Slide decks
- ✓ Worksheets
- ✓ Quizzes



“ It is the maddening, exciting, and challenging question that preoccupies anyone lucky enough to be tasked with making curriculum decisions in English. ”

Chris Fountain
English Subject Lead
Oak National Academy

Social media: video posts



Nothing ever fits perfectly

Click each example to watch, or [find more examples of video on our Twitter feed](#)

Video



[Watch this video online](#)

Email campaign

 Oak National Academy

Let's get started



Hi there, and welcome!

As promised, we'll keep you updated with news, resources and helpful guidance on [lesson planning](#) and [curriculum design](#).

New to Oak?

Did you know you can access thousands of adaptable, sequenced teaching resources in our Teacher Hub? Here's how to get started:

1. Search our [Teacher Hub](#) by subject, topic or key stage
2. Choose from editable slide decks, worksheets and quizzes
3. Download and adapt them to your needs

[Search our teaching resources](#)



"It reduces my planning time and gives me a really strong starting point for planning any lesson."

Helen, secondary science teacher



Coming soon: new resources

From autumn 2023 and throughout the coming years, we're sharing brand new curricula and teaching resources. Make sure you're the first to hear about them by [telling us the subject and phase you're interested in](#).



[Share your subject and phase](#)

Let us know how you get on

That's it from us for now. Keep an eye out for our next email in a few days showing you how to get the most out of Oak to support your lesson planning.



Matt Hood
Chief Executive
Oak National Academy

[Plan with Oak](#)



[Explore our resources](#)





Firstname Surname xxxxxxxxxxxx
Job Title xxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxx
+44 XXXX XXX XXX
thenational.academy

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Registered office: 1 Scott Place, 2 Hardman Street, Manchester, M3 3AA



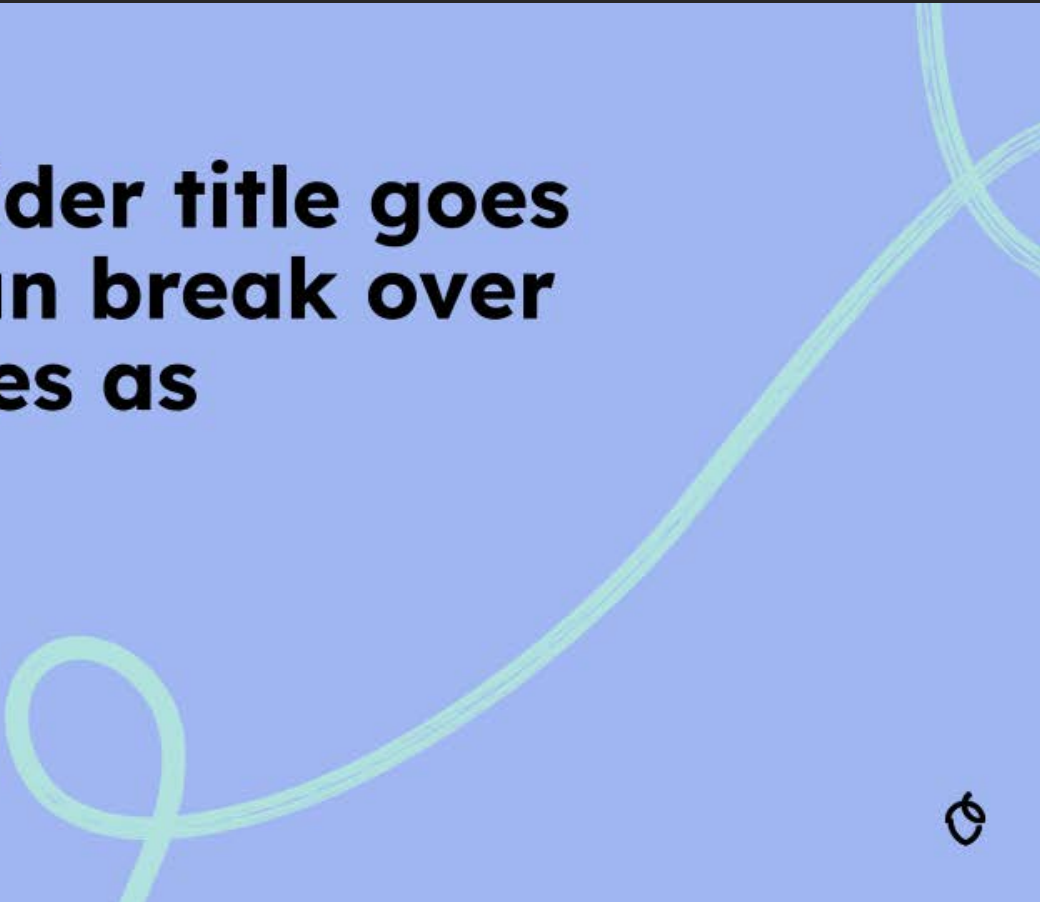


**Presentation title
over two lines**

Name of presenter
Date



**Section divider title goes
here and can break over
multiple lines as
required**



Example title

Example subtitle

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet,
consectetuer adipiscing elit. Maecenas
porttitor congue massa. Fusce posuere,
magna sed pulvinar ultricies.

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet,
consectetuer adipiscing elit. Maecenas
porttitor congue massa. Fusce posuere,
magna sed pulvinar ultricies.

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet,
consectetuer adipiscing elit. Maecenas
porttitor congue massa. Fusce posuere,
magna sed pulvinar ultricies.

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet,
consectetuer adipiscing elit. Maecenas
porttitor congue massa. Fusce posuere,
magna sed pulvinar ultricies.



Document title

Document subtitle

DATE / VERSION



Heading 1

Normal

Heading 2

Heading 3

Heading 4

Heading 5 Quote

Normal

- List bullet
 - List bullet 2
 - List bullet 3
- 1. List number
 - a. List number 2
 - i. List number

Date / Author / Other information



[Recipient name]
[Recipient address line 1]
[Recipient address line 2]
[Recipient address line 3]
[Recipient address line 4]

[DD MMMMM YYYY]

Dear [Name],

Message

Yours sincerely,

[Name Surname]
[Job title]

OAK NATIONAL ACADEMY 1 SCOTT PLACE, 2 HARDMAN STREET, MANCHESTER, M3 3AA



 Oak National Academy
Strategy 2022-2025
April 2023 update

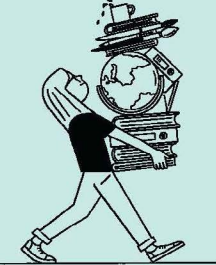
Table of contents

- 3 Welcome
- 4 About Oak
- 6 Oak’s foundations and Oak today
- 9 Oak on a page
- 10 Theory of change
- 11 Strategic goals
- 15 How we deliver our purpose
- 18 Our governance



“I have been able to help my students become more successful... when they are coming back from isolation, illness or something similar the materials are so accessible that they feel like they haven’t missed anything and are still making progress.

Our students have really low self-esteem and sometimes I don’t know where to start, but with Oak I am able to signpost them to resources which are so organised and cleverly sequenced it allows them to feel successful.”²⁰



Strategic goals

Over the next three years, in line with our [Framework Agreement](#), we will achieve three strategic goals:

- 1** Contribute to improvements in the curriculum in schools
- 2** More teachers and pupils choose to use our products, more often
- 3** Become a high-performing, well-respected part of the sector

²⁰P42, [Oak National Academy annual evaluation](#) by ImpactEd, May 2022

1 Contribute to improvements in the curriculum in schools

In 2021/22, half of Oak users reported that our curriculum and resources had increased their own confidence in curriculum design (50%), whilst 47% reported that it improved their school’s overall curriculum²¹.

We want to increase this impact further. This should not be through schools simply adopting Oak’s curriculum, but by improving expertise, empowering schools to design what’s right for them.

We’ll do this by:

- redeveloping a high-quality, broad curricula across key stages 1-4 linked to the English national curriculum, by bringing together expertise from teachers, schools and other education organisations;
- including content that provides pupils across the UK with the opportunity for learning above and beyond their school’s curriculum, and content that supports pupils with SEND;
- working with the sector to create a new set of carefully-sequenced lesson planning and teaching resources for these curricula;
- engaging teachers from across the sector in the testing of our curricula and materials;
- supporting the development of teacher creators and reviewers who take part in our processes so that they become advocates and experts in curriculum design;
- creating and sharing expertise on curriculum design within the sector, with teachers and schools through public speaking, knowledge articles and webinars;
- integrating our work into other parts of the education sector, including Initial Teacher Training and professional development providers and hubs, to create consistency in support and training;
- building product features that support teachers to understand and practise good curriculum design;
- promoting choices from other quality providers, to emphasise the plurality of approaches to curriculum.

²¹[Oak National Academy annual evaluation](#) by ImpactEd, May 2022

Lessons

For product use only

To be completed



Lesson palette

This palette is used exclusively for teaching resources. The deep colours ensure that content can easily be seen when projected onto a whiteboard or printed.

These colours can be used as a background for headings, quotes, and highlights, using white (#ffffff) text. They can also be used in graphic devices and icons.

They are not used as background colours for whole slides or when dealing with lots of text. They can be used however at a 10% tint.

This palette is not used in marketing or any other materials.

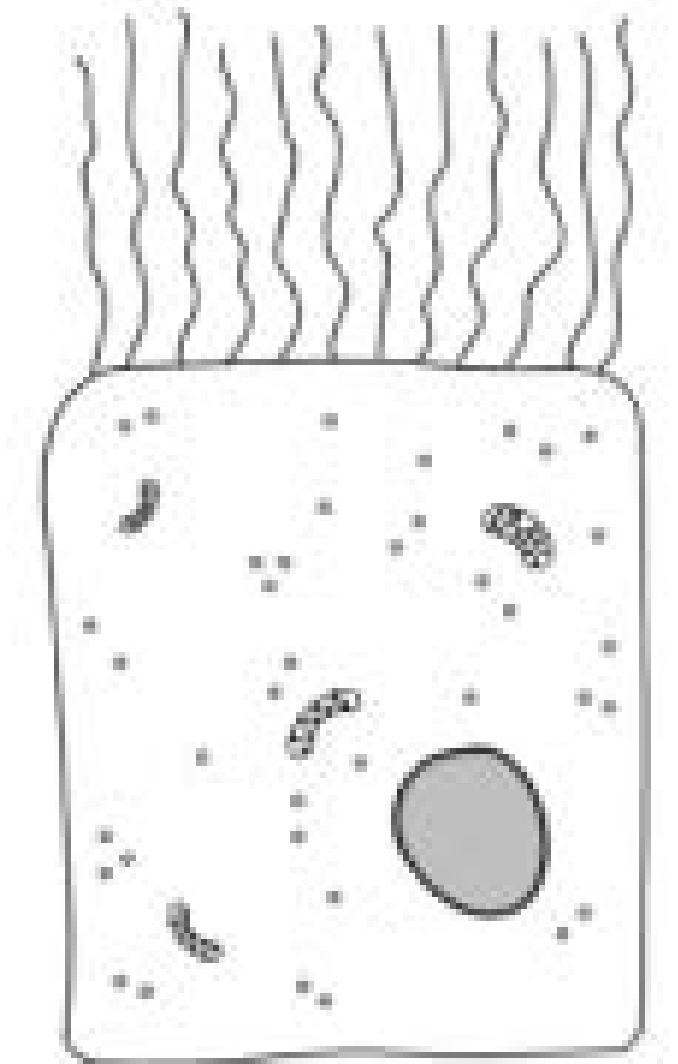
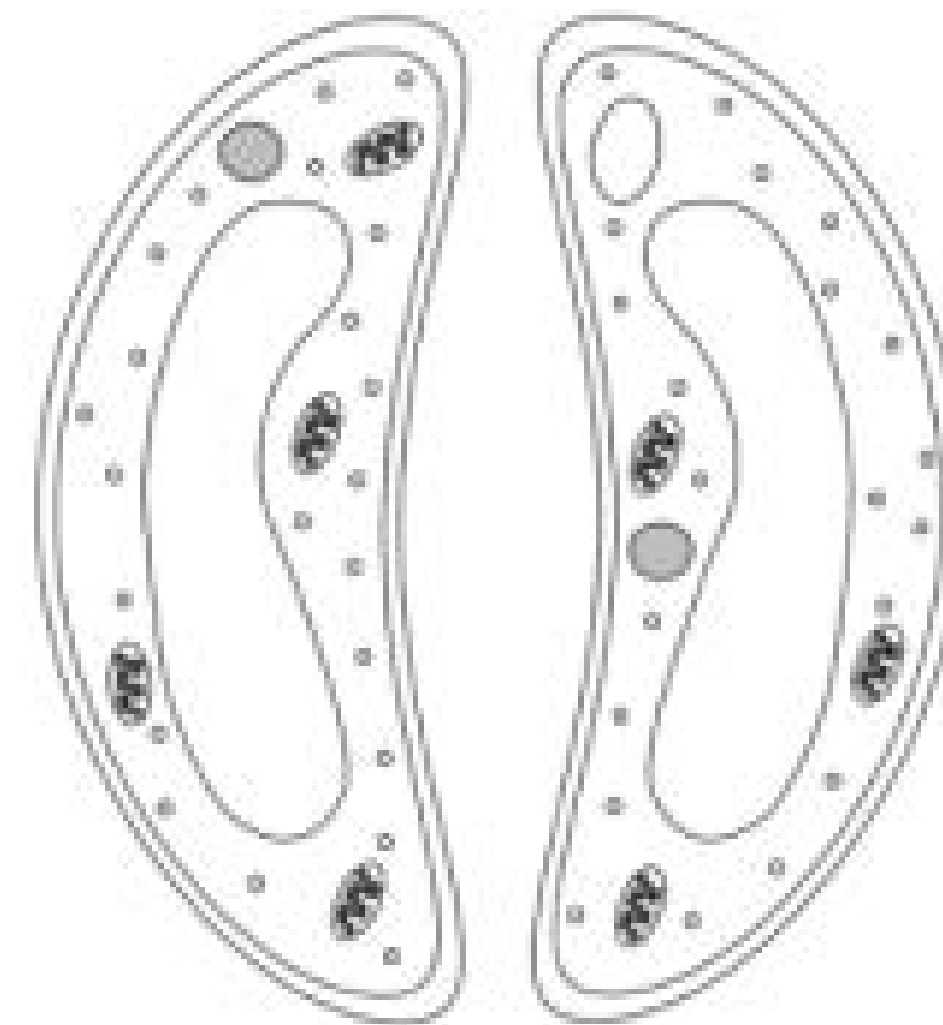
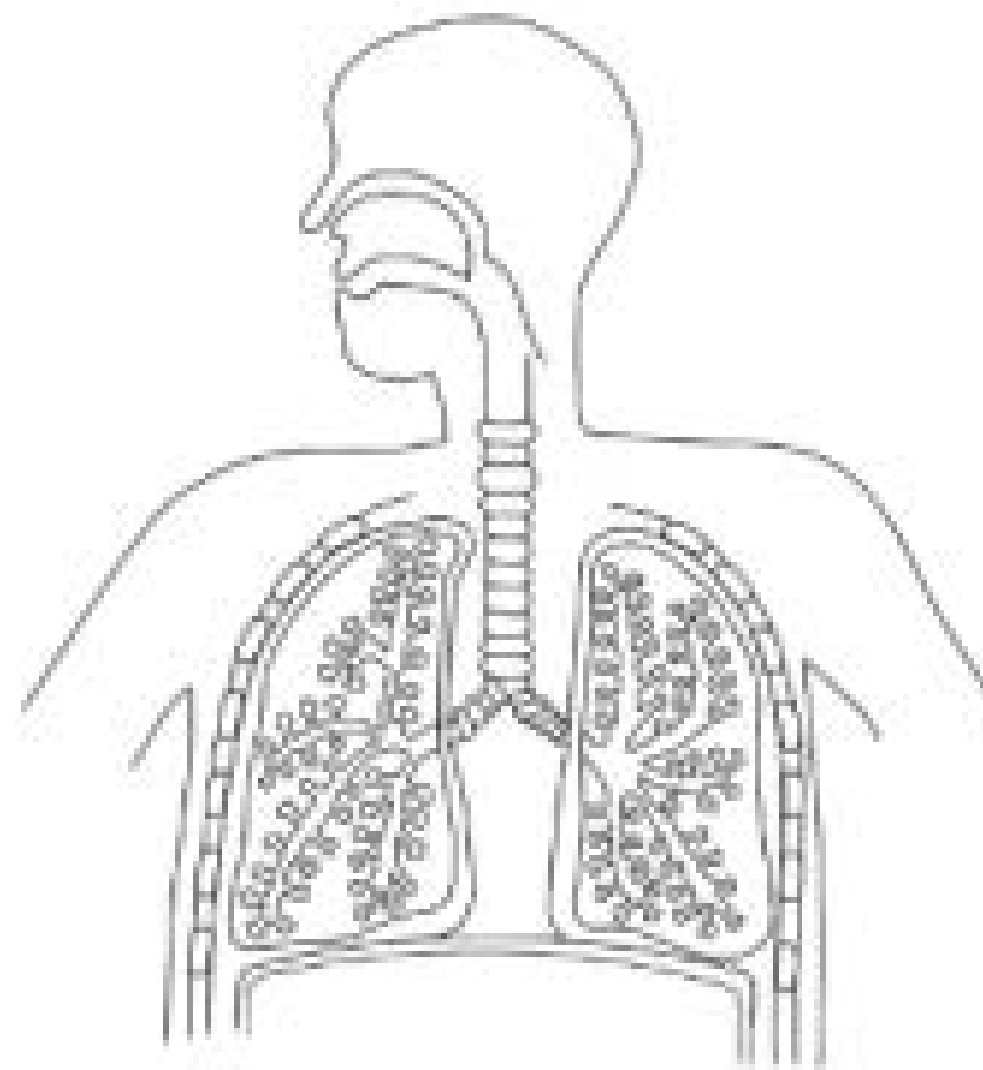
Blue	Magenta	Teal	Red	Purple
Screen R55 G76 B241 Hex #374CF1	Screen R208 G42 B167 Hex #D02AA7	Screen R3 G123 B125 Hex #037B7D	Screen R229 G29 B77 Hex #E5AD4D	Screen R132 G90 B217 Hex #845AD9
Print CMYK 85/60/0/0	Print CMYK 10/100/0/0	Print CMYK 84/30/47/10	Print CMYK 0/95/55/0	Print CMYK 70/70/0/0
10% tint	10% tint	10% tint	10% tint	10% tint

Lesson illustrations: scientific illustrations and diagrams

These are used in our lesson slides where the drawing itself is the focus of the learning.

They are simple line drawings, using clean, joined-up lines, and are predominately black and white. Colour is used if it has a specific purpose or meaning (ideally using our palette, unless specific colours are needed). They do not have backgrounds.

If they have labels, lines should not cross; any letters or numbers should be sequenced left to right, top to bottom, or clockwise.



Lesson illustrations: illustrations depicting a scene or character

These support storytelling eg. famous people, fiction stories. They are more frequently used in primary lessons and can use colour.

They are not overly complicated; the subject should be the focus of attention. Subjects should only have a background if it supports learning and provides context e.g. a time period or habitat, and scenery should be simplistic and relevant to the period of time.

Subject should have realistic proportions, colours and features, and should not be cartoonish.



In practice: lesson slides

TBA

In practice: lesson worksheets

TBA

Notes

File navigation

For Oak colleagues, further brand support can be found on **Our Intranet**; and individual files, such as logos and illustrations, can be found in the **Brand** folder in the **Oak Core Team** shared drive.

External suppliers and partners can find our assets [here](#).

Support

Thank you for taking the time to learn about our brand. You should now have all the tools you need to communicate our message effectively, but if you do still have questions, you can contact Chloë Wallis, Brand and Content Officer, at **chloe.wallis@thenational.academy**.

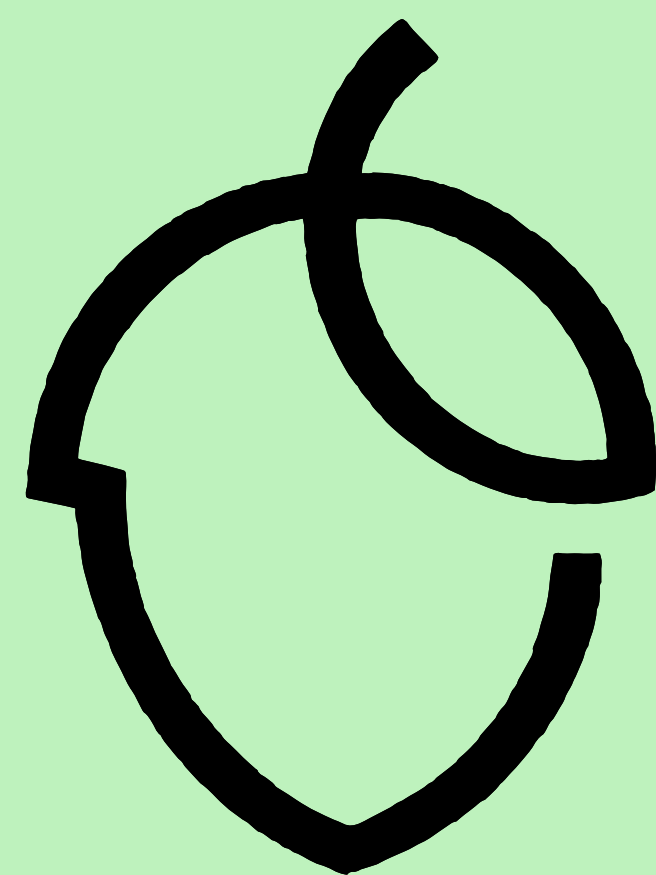
Print

Oak is completely online, so we mostly work with Hex (and RGB) values. For the rare occasions we do work in print, e.g. for marketing / event display materials, we have identified CMYK values for our palettes. Please liaise School Support team when working with print.

Mint CMYK 30/0/36/0		50% tint CMYK 10/0/11/6	
Black 0/0/0/87	White 0/0/0/0	Green 33/0/28/51	

Aqua 40/0/20/0	Lavender 42/25/0/0	Pink 0/37/0/0	Lemon 0/6/70/0
50% tint 10/0/1/9	50% tint 16/12/0/6	50% tint 0/8/2/10	50% tint 0/5/34/4

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